Travel and Expense Policy

Kestrel Data Labs Pvt. Ltd. (fictional company created for this project)

1. Booking travel

All business travel must be booked through the company travel desk, TravelHub, at least 14 days before departure where possible. Travel needs approval from the reporting manager before booking.

2. Air travel

Economy class is the standard for all flights with a scheduled duration of up to 6 hours. For flights longer than 6 hours, employees at level L5 and above may book business class; employees below L5 may book premium economy. Upgrades paid for personally are allowed.

3. Accommodation

Hotel stays are capped at INR 7,000 per night in metro cities (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata) and INR 4,500 per night in other Indian cities. International hotels are capped at USD 180 per night unless pre-approved.

4. Daily allowance (per diem)

The daily allowance for meals and local incidentals is INR 2,500 per day for domestic travel and USD 75 per day for international travel. Per diem is not paid for days on which meals are provided by a client or a conference.

5. Submitting expenses

Expense claims must be submitted in PeopleDesk within 30 days of returning from a trip. Itemised receipts are required for every expense above INR 500. Claims submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed.

6. Non-reimbursable items

The company does not reimburse alcohol, traffic or parking fines, personal entertainment, minibar charges, or travel insurance bought separately (all business travellers are covered by the corporate travel insurance policy).